

21.7 Summary and Notes

21.7.1 Summary

Idea.

1. Residuals mix all the errors. Each differs from its error with variance $\sigma^2 h_{ii}$, and residuals keep only part of the errors' skewness and kurtosis, so they look more normal than the errors when p/n is not small (Proposition 21.1.1).
2. Normal plots of studentized residuals with simulated envelopes are the main check of normality. Coefficient inference is protected by the central limit theorem; prediction intervals are not, and their coverage tends to $\Pr(|\varepsilon_0| \leq z\sigma)$ (Proposition 12.3.3), which Table 21.1.1 evaluates for five error laws.
3. The Breusch–Pagan statistic is half the explained sum of squares of $\hat{\varepsilon}_i^2/\hat{\sigma}^2$ on the variance variables, whatever the variance function. Non-normal errors inflate its null law by $(\kappa - 1)/2$, with κ the raw kurtosis, and Koenker's nR^2 corrects this (Theorem 21.2.2, using Lemma 21.2.1). The Goldfeld–Quandt test is exact under normality (Proposition 21.2.3).
4. Weighted least squares is optimal with known weights, unbiased with wrong ones, unbiased under symmetric errors with weights from residuals, and asymptotically optimal with weights from well-replicated groups (Theorem 21.3.1). Weights from a few replicates can be worse than none.
5. HC0–HC3 estimate the covariance of least squares without a variance model (Definition 21.4.1). HC2 is unbiased under homoscedasticity and HC3 is the jackknife (Proposition 21.4.1). All are consistent (Theorem 21.4.2), but high leverage makes them unreliable in small samples.
6. Given $\mathbf{X}$ and normal errors, the Durbin–Watson $d \approx 2(1 - r_1)$ is a ratio of quadratic forms with a computable law, bracketed by design-free bounds when there is an intercept (Theorem 21.5.3, Lemma 21.5.1, Lemma 21.5.2).
7. AR(1) errors are whitened by the Prais–Winsten transformation, and Cochrane–Orcutt iteration decreases the conditional sum of squares (Definition 21.6.1, Theorem 21.6.1). Smooth regressors make least squares efficient but its standard errors wrong. Newey–West estimates are nonnegative definite (Proposition 21.6.2). Residual autocorrelation often signals missing dynamics.

21.7.2 Notes and sources

Sources. The chapter covers Sen and Srivastava (1990, chapters 5–6 and sections 7.1–7.3 and 7.6), Seber and Lee (2003, sections 10.4–10.5) and Christensen (2020, sections 12.2–12.4). It adds proofs of the facts about residuals behind the diagnostics, the null limits of both forms of the Breusch–Pagan test, the properties of feasible weighting in the grouped case, the consistency of the sandwich estimators, and the Durbin–Watson bounds through interlacing. The limit theorems are from van der Vaart (1998).

Normality. Blom (1958) gave the plotting positions, Shapiro and Wilk (1965) and Shapiro and Francia (1972) the two correlation-type tests, and Jarque and Bera (1980) the skewness–kurtosis score test. Lilliefors (1967) tabulated the Kolmogorov–Smirnov test with estimated parameters,

and Anderson and Darling (1952) introduced their tail-weighted distance. Simulated envelopes are due to Atkinson (1981). That residuals look more normal than errors is an old observation; Proposition 21.1.1(c) quantifies it.

Heteroscedasticity. The score test is due to Breusch and Pagan (1979) and to Cook and Weisberg (1983); the score principle is Rao's (1948). Koenker (1981) exposed the sensitivity to kurtosis and gave the studentized form. White (1980) proposed the direct test and the covariance estimator, and Goldfeld and Quandt (1965) the exact F test. Levene (1960) and Brown and Forsythe (1974) gave robust tests for groups, and Box (1953) showed the non-robustness of normal-theory variance tests. Carroll and Ruppert (1988) is the standard monograph on weighting; Carroll (1982) showed that weights estimated by smoothing can be fully efficient asymptotically. The symmetry argument of Theorem 21.3.1(c) goes back to Kakwani (1967).

Sandwich estimators. Eicker (1963) gave conditions for asymptotic normality of least squares with unequal variances and Eicker (1967) the consistency of the covariance estimator; Huber (1967) introduced the sandwich form for general estimators, and White (1980) made it standard in econometrics. MacKinnon and White (1985) proposed HC2 and HC3. Long and Ervin (2000) recommended HC3, and Imbens and Kolesár (2016) recommend HC2 with the degrees-of-freedom adjustment of Bell and McCaffrey (2002).

Serial correlation. Durbin and Watson (1950, 1951, 1971) introduced the statistic and the bounds and studied its exact distribution; Imhof (1961) gave the inversion formula. Durbin (1970) treated lagged responses, Breusch (1978) and Godfrey (1978) the score test for higher-order errors, and Ljung and Box (1978) the portmanteau statistic. The transformations are those of Cochran and Orcutt (1949) and Prais and Winsten (1954). Grenander (1954) proved the asymptotic efficiency of least squares for polynomial trends. Newey and West (1987) proposed the Bartlett-weighted estimator and Andrews (1991) studied its bandwidth. Hendry and Mizon (1978) argued for testing the common factor restriction, and Granger and Newbold (1974) exposed spurious regressions. Fuller (1996) gives the asymptotic theory of regression with autocorrelated errors in full.

21.7.3 References

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